

Getting started with vegan Dubai

A small guide to eating out, shopping and making a few good meals at home.



Eating out

Look for a vegan menu, or ask the staff what can be made without meat, fish, dairy, eggs or honey. Sauces, stocks, dressings and desserts are worth checking.

If you have an allergy, say so separately. Vegan does not automatically mean free of nuts, soy, sesame or gluten.

A first shopping list

Rice or bread; lentils or chickpeas; vegetables; fruit; tahini; herbs and spices; canned tomatoes; lemon. These can become soups, bowls, wraps and quick salads.

Read labels on packaged food. Milk powder, whey, egg and honey can appear in products that look vegan at first glance.

Places to explore

Top Vegan by Dobrow

Jumeirah Lakes Towers

Planet Terra

The Greens

Wild & The Moon

Alserkal Avenue

Two easy vegan meals

Use these as a starting point. Adjust quantities to your appetite and season to taste.

Tomato and lentil pot

You need: red lentils, onion, garlic, canned tomatoes, cumin, vegetable stock and lemon.

Soften the onion and garlic in a little oil. Add cumin, lentils, tomatoes and enough stock to cover. Simmer until the lentils are soft. Finish with lemon. Eat with rice or bread.

Chickpea and tahini bowl

You need: cooked chickpeas, cucumber, tomato, greens, tahini, lemon and rice.

Put warm rice and chickpeas in a bowl. Add chopped vegetables. Thin tahini with lemon juice and a little water, then spoon it over the top.

Finding people

Search for vegan events in Dubai on Eventbrite and Meetup. Check the organiser, venue and date before making plans. You can arrive curious: there is no test to pass.

Keep exploring

Visit the Dubai Vegan Community site for restaurant links, recipes, future events and community stories.

sultan-a2.github.io/dubai-vegan-community/edition.html